Longhorns Briefing

Mentor project summary | Ry | November 2, 2026

WHAT THE PROJECT DOES

A local web app generates sourced Texas Longhorns postgame briefings from the 2023 season. Users select a game or ask by opponent, reviewed nickname, or season order. The result includes statistical comparisons, evidence references, limitations, and usage totals. It has no live sports feed or predictions.

GLASS-TO-METAL WORKFLOW

Python validates the selected game and controls a sequential research-to-writer workflow. The research model proposes calls to two approved tools: **list_games** and **get_game_data**. The application validates and dispatches those calls through a local stdio MCP server. Retrieval functions query MySQL, then return structured evidence to the application. A separate writer context receives that evidence without tools. Output checks precede display. Both roles use OpenAI Luna with low reasoning effort; a typical verified run used four model requests.

DATA FOUNDATION

CFBD records are normalized into MySQL: **15 teams, 14 games, and 28 team-game statistics rows**. Original responses, hashes, source metadata, and import history preserve traceability. Unique source identities and upserts prevent duplicates; transactions protect against partial dataset writes. Schedule and selected box-score comparisons support the source evaluation.

INDEPENDENT GUARDRAILS

Application: localhost-only serving, origin/request-token checks, server-side game validation, approved tools and schemas, bounded queries/calls/time/usage, and sanitized audit metadata. Credentials stay server-side; no arbitrary SQL, shell, or file tools are exposed to the model.
Database: the MCP identity has SELECT-only access to approved views, independently of model behavior. Import and administrator identities are separate. Queries are fixed and parameterized; the writer has no retrieval tools.

VERIFICATION AND KNOWN LIMITS

41 Python tests and 102 search cases, real MCP/database integration, denied-operation checks, and scoped live missing-data/injection evaluations provide evidence for tested behavior. A richer-output live sample matched retrieved statistics; earlier live injection cases predate that prompt revision. Citation checks establish linkage, not factual correctness.
Main isolation gap: MySQL is containerized, but the app and MCP processes share an OS user; same-user or privileged processes can read secret files. The demo has no user login, production web deployment, or hard dollar spending cap. Browser review is manual, not automated.

NEXT STEPS AND LEARNING

Confirm VM readiness and permissions, then deploy with environment-specific credential isolation, access, networking, persistence, and recovery decisions. Next explore web-assisted alias checks; current aliases remain reviewed static configuration. Further features are deferred. Codex assisted planning, implementation, and review; Ry directed scope and reviewed behavior and concepts.